2	**Medicinal plant**	*Thevetia peruviana* (lucky nut/ தங்கஅலரி) *Vallaris solanacea* *Alstonia scholaris* *Wrightia tomentosa* (பாலை) *Catharanthus roseus*	Seeds Latex Bark Bark and Roots Aerial parts	Used in rheumatism Useful in toothache and to treat inflated gums. Used in malaria and dysentery. Used as antidote to snakebite. Used to treat muscle pain, the alkaloids like vin-blastine and vincristine are mainly used to treat various human cancers.
3.	**Dye yielding plant**	*Wrightia tinctoria*	Seeds	An indigo- like dye is obtained from the seeds.
4.	***Ornamental plants***	*Allamanda nerifolia* (golden trumpet), *Alstonia scholaris,* *Catharanthus roseus,* *Nerium indicum* *Plumeria alba,*	plant	Grown as ornamentals plants.

5.13.3 Family: Solanaceae (Potato Family / Night shade family)



Systematic Position

APG system of classification		Bentham and Hooker system of classification	
Kingdom	Plantae	Kingdom	Plantae
Clade	Angiosperms	Class	Dicotyledonae
Clade	Eudicot	Subclass	Gamopetalae
Clade	Asterids	Series	Bicarpellatae
Clade	Solanales	Order	Polemoniales
Family	Solanaceae	Family	Solanaceae

General Characters

Distribution:

Family Solanaceae includes about 88 genera and about 2650 species, of these *Solanum* is the largest genus of the family with about 1500 species. Plants are worldwide in distribution but more abundant in South America.

Habit: Mostly annual herbs, shrubs, small trees (*Solanum violaceum*) lianas with prickles (*Solanum trilobatum*)

Root: Branched tap root system.

Stem: Herbaceous or woody; erect or twining, or creeping; sometimes modified into tubers (*Solanum tuberosum*) it is covered with Spines (*Solanum tuberosum)*

Leaves: Alternate, simple, rarely pinnately compound (*Solanum tuberosum* and *Lycopersicon esculentum*, exstipulate, opposite or sub-opposite in upper part, unicostate reticulate venation. Yellowish verbs present in *Solanum tuberosum*

Inflorescence: Generally axillary or terminal cymose (*Solanum*) or solitary flowers (*Datura stramonium*). Extra axillary

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